

Mahta Ghafarianghadim

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Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA 30303

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics (Expected 2027), Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA

M.A. in Economics (2025), Georgia State University, Atlanta, GA

M.A. in Energy Economics (2020), Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran

B.A. in Theoretical Economics (2018), Allameh Tabataba'i University, Tehran, Iran

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Environmental Economics, Health Economics, Applied Microeconomics, Causal Inference, Policy Evaluation

WORKING PAPERS

1. "Air Pollution and Cardiovascular Mortality: Evidence from Thermal Inversions in the U.S."

Job Market Paper

2. "Mental Health and Functional Consequences of Smoking: A Causal Approach Using Misreporting Corrections."

3. "Assessing the Causal Impact of Air Pollution on Childcare Outcomes in the U.S."

Joint with Garth Heutel

Under review at the Journal of Environmental Economics and Management (JEEM). NBER Working Paper No: W35367.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"The Effect of Targeted Regulation of Abortion Providers (TRAP) Laws on Food Insecurity in the U.S."

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant, Georgia State University 2022–Present

Study causal effects of air pollution on childcare attendance using administrative and satellite data.

Build high-frequency panel datasets with instrumental variables and fixed-effects.

Manage restricted-access administrative datasets under data use agreements from Georgia's Department of Early Care and Learning.

Research Assistant, Allameh Tabataba'i University 2020–2021

Design decomposition analysis, Integrated Inoperability Input-Output (IIOM), and Mixed Input-Output (MIOM) methods.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Georgia State University

Environmental Economics and Policy (ECON 4220, Online/Asynchronous)

Summer 2026

4.9/5.0 (Summer 2026, n=79)

Principles of Microeconomics (ECON 2106, In Person)

Fall 2025, Spring 2026

4.6/5.0 (Fall 2025, n=112); 4.7/5.0 (Spring 2026, n=118)

Teaching Assistant

Georgia State University	2022–2024
Public Economics	
Principles of Microeconomics	
Intermediate Microeconomics	
Allameh Tabataba'i University	2018–2021
Intermediate Microeconomics	

Teaching Certification

Georgia State University	
Mastering Online Teaching: Course Accessibility	2026

PRE-PH.D. PEER REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

1. Faridzad, A. and **Ghafarian Ghadim, M.** 2022. "CO₂ Intensity Decomposition Analysis in the Netherlands' Manufacturing Industry: An Application of Monetary and Physical Indicators." *Environment, Development and Sustainability*, 25(8), 8799–8817.
2. **Ghafarian Ghadim, M.** and Faridzad, A. 2021. "Composite Energy Intensity Index Estimation in Iran: An Exploration of Index Decomposition Analysis." *Polityka Energetyczna (Energy Policy Journal)*, 24(1), 5–28.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2026:

American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Annual Conference (Minneapolis, MN), Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Conference (Houston, TX, forthcoming), Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference (Boston, MA, forthcoming)

2025:

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference (Seattle, WA)

HONORS, AWARDS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Dan E. Sweat Dissertation Fellowship for Policy-Related Research, Georgia State University	2026
Selected Participant, WEAI Graduate Student Workshop, Denver, CO (Funded)	2026
NBER Environmental and Energy Policy and the Economy Conference, Washington, D.C.	2026
Berkeley Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics, UC Berkeley (Funded)	2025
Dunn Fellowship and Research Fund, Georgia State University	2023–2025
Ranked 1st among M.A. Economics students, Allameh Tabataba'i University	2020

SKILLS

Econometric Methods: Instrumental Variables, Difference-in-Differences, Fixed Effects, Panel Data

Programming: Stata, Python (pandas, numpy), SAS, QGIS, Excel

Data: NCHS restricted mortality microdata, BRFSS, Medicaid claims, CAPS administrative data (Georgia DECAL), NASA satellite data

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Session Chair

“Public Health and Economic Impacts of Environmental Stressors,” American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Annual Conference (Minneapolis, MN, 2026)

“Environmental Determinants of Health: Evidence from Air, Water, and Heat,” APPAM Fall Research Conference Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference (Seattle, WA, 2025)

“Environmental Justice and Distributional Equity” Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference, Boston (MA, forthcoming, 2026)

Judge

GSU Undergraduate Research Conference (GSURC, 2025)

Summer Undergraduate Research Symposium (SURS, 2025)

Conference Abstract Reviewer

2026 APPAM Fall Research Conference

2025 ASHEcon Annual Conference

Referee

American Journal of Health Economics

Taylor and Francis, Climate Policy

Emerald Publishing, International Journal of Energy Sector Management (×2)

Springer Nature, Journal of Population Economics

Elsevier, Economics and Human Biology (×2)

Springer Nature, Energy Efficiency Journal (×3)

Associations

American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon)

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)

Western Economic Association International (WEAI)

Southern Economic Association (SEA)

REFERENCES

Dr. Garth Heutel

Professor, Department of Economics, Georgia State University

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Dr. James Marton

Professor, Department of Economics, Georgia State University

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Dr. Rusty Tchernis

Professor, Department of Economics, Georgia State University

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Dr. Paulina Oliva

Professor, Department of Economics, University of Southern California

olivaval@usc.edu